



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*tāmāha prahasandevo devīm kamalalocanām |
brahmāṇaṁ devi varadamārādhaya śucismite || 20 ||
sā tatheti pratijñāya tapastaptuṁ pracakrame |
rudraśca tārṣṇāha śṛṇudhvaṁ mama toṣaṇe |
phalaṁ phalavatām śreṣṭhā yadbravīmi tapodhanāḥ || 21 ||
amarā jarayā tyaktā arogā janmavarjitāḥ |
madbhaktāstapasā yuktā ihaiva ca nivatsyatha || 22 ||*

— Skandapurāṇa, Chapter 9, Verses 20-22

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Skandapurāṇa unfolds a scene of divine counsel and profound promise. The deity, smiling, speaks to the lotus-eyed Devi, advising her to worship Brahma, the boon-giver. This act of seeking blessings through devotion is a foundational principle in Hindu spirituality, showing us that even divine beings engage in practices to achieve their goals. The Devi, accepting this instruction with a firm resolve, embarks on rigorous tapas, or spiritual austerity. This illustrates the importance of commitment and sustained effort in your own spiritual journey.

Simultaneously, Rudra addresses the sages, revealing the supreme fruit of pleasing him, highlighting a path to liberation accessible to all. He proclaims that his devotees, those engaged in tapas, will be freed from decay, disease, and rebirth, dwelling eternally in his presence. This promise transcends the literal interpretation of physical immortality. It speaks to the potential for transcending the limitations of the ego and the cycle of suffering through devotion and dedicated practice.

In modern life, this passage serves as a powerful reminder that the pursuit of spiritual growth is not about escaping the world, but about transforming your experience within it. By dedicating yourself to practices that cultivate inner peace, compassion, and wisdom – be it meditation, selfless service, or creative expression – you too can experience a taste of this divine liberation. You can begin to dismantle the causes of suffering and live with greater joy, resilience, and purpose. The key is to find what truly resonates with your heart and to commit to it wholeheartedly, just as the Devi committed to her tapas. Rudra's promise is not just for ancient sages; it's a possibility open to anyone who sincerely seeks it.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What small, consistent practice could you incorporate into your daily life to cultivate greater inner peace and move toward liberation from suffering?